

ITIL Incident Management Summary

ITIL 4 Framework for Enterprise Service Management

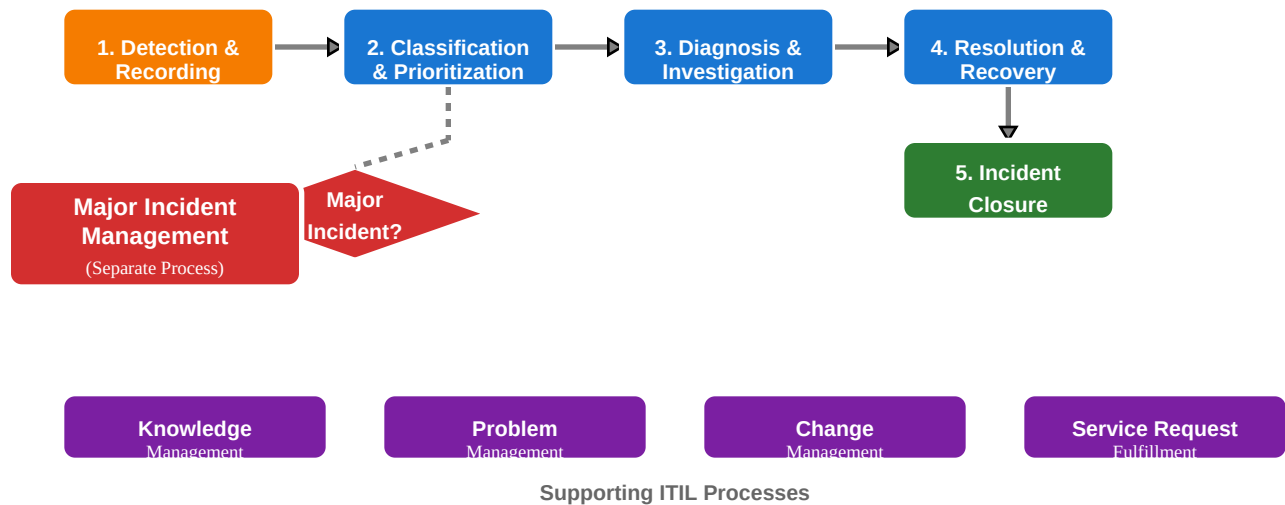
1. Incident Management Overview

Incident Management is the ITIL process responsible for managing the lifecycle of all incidents. The primary objective is to restore normal service operation as quickly as possible while minimizing adverse impact on business operations.

Key Objectives:

- Restore normal service operation quickly
- Minimize business impact and disruption
- Ensure incidents are resolved within agreed SLA timeframes
- Maintain quality and availability of IT services
- Improve user and customer satisfaction

1.1 Incident Lifecycle Stages



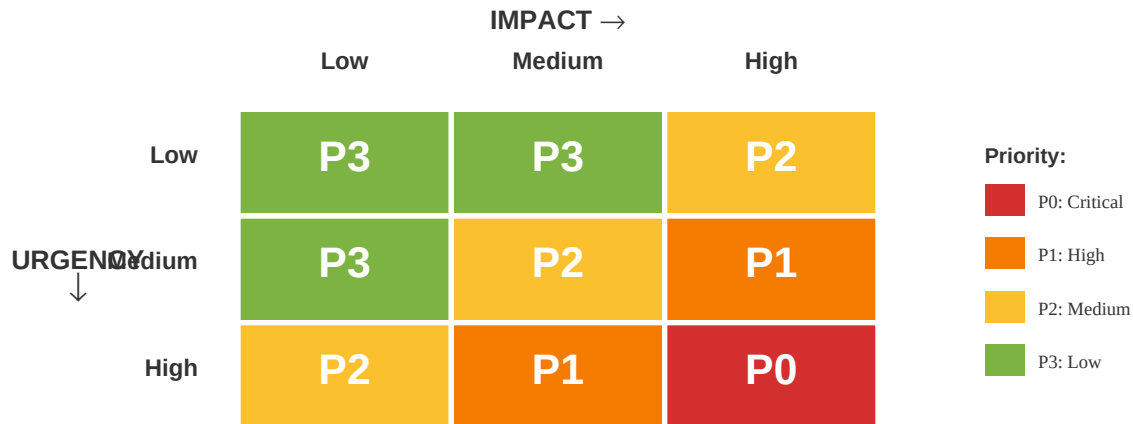
2. Incident Lifecycle Stage Details

Stage	Activities	Key Outputs	Tools/Methods
1. Detection & Recording	• Identify incident source • Create incident record • Assign unique ticket ID • Capture initial details	Incident ticket with: - Timestamp - Reporter - Symptoms	• ITSM tool • Monitoring alerts • User reports • Service desk
2. Classification & Prioritization	• Categorize by type • Assess urgency • Determine impact • Calculate priority	Priority (P0-P3) based on urgency × impact matrix	• Priority matrix • Service catalog • SLA database

3. Diagnosis & Investigation	• Gather information • Identify symptoms • Check knowledge base • Investigate root cause	Diagnosis with: - Probable cause - Resolution path	• Knowledge base • Diagnostic tools • Error logs • Known errors
4. Resolution & Recovery	• Implement fix • Test solution • Restore service • Confirm with user	Service restored to normal operation	• Change mgmt • Config mgmt • Workarounds • Escalation
5. Incident Closure	• Verify resolution • Update records • User satisfaction • Document lessons	Closed ticket with: - Resolution - Time metrics - Feedback	• ITSM closure • Surveys • KB updates • Trend analysis

3. Incident Prioritization

Priority is determined by assessing both the **urgency** (how quickly resolution is needed) and **impact** (extent of business disruption) of the incident.



Level	Impact Definition	Urgency Definition
High	- Affects multiple users/services - Critical business function down - Revenue/compliance impact	- Immediate resolution required - Business operations stopped - SLA breach imminent
Medium	- Affects single user/department - Important but not critical - Workaround available	- Resolution needed today - Reduced productivity - Can wait few hours
Low	- Minimal business impact - Cosmetic issues - Individual convenience	- Can be scheduled - No immediate pressure - Next business day OK

4. Major Incident Management

A **Major Incident** is the highest category of impact requiring separate procedures and expedited resolution processes.

Criteria	Threshold	Examples
User Impact	> 100 users OR > 25% of user base	Email system down, network outage, authentication failure
Business Impact	Critical business function unavailable	E-commerce site down, payment processing halted
Financial Impact	> \$50,000/hour revenue loss	Production system outage, order processing stopped
Duration	Outage > 4 hours for critical service	Prolonged degradation of essential services
Security	Data breach or active security incident	Ransomware, data exfiltration, unauthorized access
Compliance	Regulatory violation or SLA breach	GDPR data exposure, contractual SLA failure

4.1 Major Incident Procedure

- **Immediate actions:** Convene incident response team, establish war room/bridge
- **Communication:** Executive notification, status page updates, stakeholder briefings
- **Coordination:** Incident manager coordinates all technical teams

- **Documentation:** Real-time incident log, timeline tracking
- **Resolution:** All-hands effort, workarounds prioritized, change mgmt expedited
- **Post-incident:** Mandatory post-mortem within 48 hours

5. Root Cause Analysis (RCA) Requirements

RCA is mandatory for all P0 and P1 incidents, and recommended for recurring P2 incidents. The goal is to identify the underlying cause and prevent recurrence.

Phase	Activities	Deliverables	Timeline
1. Data Collection	• Gather logs, metrics • Interview stakeholders • Document timeline • Collect evidence	Complete incident timeline with all actions and events	Within 24 hours of resolution
2. Root Cause Identification	• 5 Whys analysis • Fishbone diagram • Fault tree analysis • Identify contributing factors	Root cause(s) and contributing factors identified	Within 3 days
3. Corrective Actions	• Define preventive measures • Assign owners • Set implementation dates • Risk assessment	Action plan with: - Remediation - Prevention - Detection	Within 5 days
4. Documentation & Review	• Write RCA report • Present to stakeholders • Update knowledge base • Share lessons learned	Published RCA report with action tracking	Within 7 days

5.1 RCA Report Structure

- **Executive Summary:** Impact, duration, business cost, resolution
- **Incident Timeline:** Chronological sequence of events with timestamps
- **Root Cause:** Primary cause and contributing factors
- **5 Whys Analysis:** Drill-down questioning to find root cause
- **Action Items:** Short-term fixes and long-term preventive measures
- **Lessons Learned:** What worked well, what needs improvement
- **Follow-up Plan:** Action owner assignments with due dates

5.2 Key Incident Metrics

Metric	Definition	Target
MTTR	Mean Time To Resolve (detection to resolution)	P0: < 4hrs, P1: < 24hrs
MTTA	Mean Time To Acknowledge (detection to assignment)	P0: < 15min, P1: < 1hr
First Call Resolution	% of incidents resolved on first contact	> 70%
Escalation Rate	% of incidents escalated to L2/L3	< 25%
Reopen Rate	% of incidents reopened after closure	< 5%
SLA Compliance	% of incidents meeting response/resolution SLAs	> 95%

ITIL Incident Management Resources

ITIL Foundation: <https://www.axelos.com/certifications/itil-service-management>
Incident Management Guide: <https://docs.example.com/itil/incident-management>
Training & Certification: servicedesk@example.com